

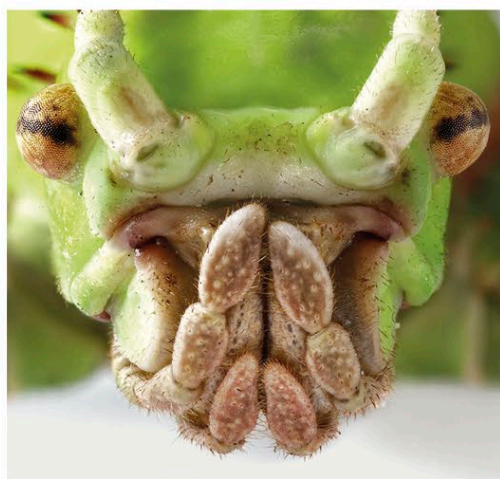
JUNGLE NYMPH STICK INSECT

Heteropteryx dilatata

This species is also known as the Malayan jungle nymph. Females are large, with bright green coloration on their upper surface and darker green below. The adult male is much smaller, more slender, and darker in colour. Both have wings, but the female is flightless. Nymphs and adults feed on the foliage of a range of different plants, including durian, guava, and mango. Mature females with eggs can be very aggressive. If disturbed, they make a loud hissing sound using their short wings, and splay their strong, spiny hind legs in a defensive posture. If attacked, they will kick out. This lively, nocturnal species has become a popular pet worldwide.

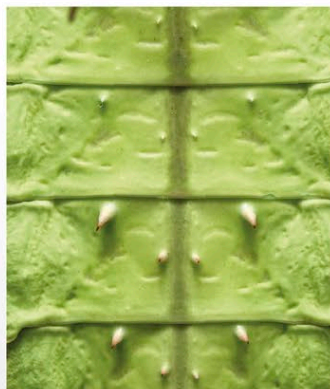
MOUTHPARTS >

At rest the jaws are concealed behind two pairs of food-handling appendages called palps. These are covered with sensory organs, which enable the insect to taste the surface of the leaves it feeds on.



SEGMENTED BODY >

The tough, spiny plates that make up the body segments are joined by soft membranes that allow flexibility.



^ OVIPOSITOR

The female – which can lay up to 150 eggs in her lifetime – uses her ovipositor to lay her large eggs one at a time, concealed in leaf litter or moist soil.



^ > FOOT

The foot is made up of a number of short tarsal segments and a long, spiny terminal segment, which bears a pair of sharp, curved claws.



SIZE Up to 15.5 cm (6 in)
HABITAT Tropical forest
DISTRIBUTION Malaysia
DIET Foliage of various plants

< COMPOUND EYE

Compound eyes – typical of insects – do not need to be as acute as those of many predatory arthropods, but they do need to be able to detect movement and potential enemies.



long, segmented antennae sense the immediate environment, including air movements

